1. Overview

This guide documents how the home network is set up so anyone in the house can troubleshoot it. The ISP modem is in bridge mode and the Eero mesh handles routing, DHCP and Wi-Fi.

Main network: 'Sheppard-Home' (WPA3). Guest network: 'Sheppard-Guest', isolated from local devices. IoT devices (thermostat, robot vacuum, smart plugs) live on a separate 2.4 GHz SSID so they don't slow down laptops.

2. Mesh placement

Primary node: office, wired to the modem. Second node: upstairs hallway on the bookshelf - keep it off the floor and away from the aquarium. Third node: garage, wired via the powerline adapter because the wireless backhaul through the concrete wall was unreliable.

If speeds drop upstairs, check that the hallway node shows a 'great' connection in the app. Moving it 1-2 meters toward the stairs usually fixes it.

3. Troubleshooting checklist

1) Is it one device or all devices? If one device, forget the network and rejoin.
2) Check the ISP status page for outages before restarting anything.
3) Restart order matters: modem first, wait two minutes, then the primary Eero, then the satellites.
4) The printer needs a DHCP reservation (192.168.4.50) or AirPrint stops finding it.
5) Firmware updates install automatically at 3am; occasional 3am disconnects are expected.